



# Building Skills for the TOEFL® iBT

**Beginning**

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**WRITING**

# Chapter 1

## Thinking and Writing

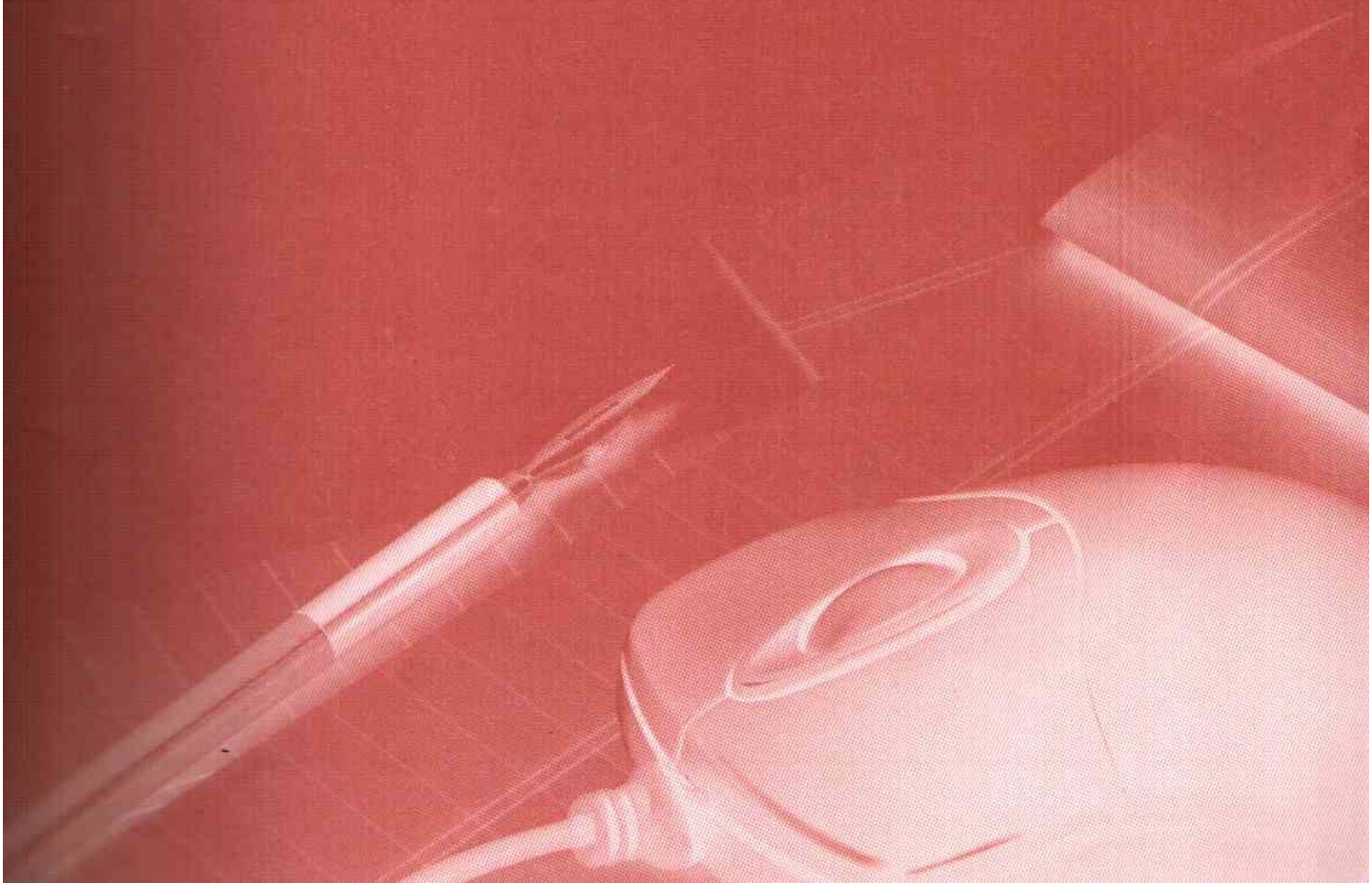
**Skill A** Integrated Writing: Organizing Information

**Skill B** Integrated Writing: Integrated Writing: Paraphrasing

**Skill C** Independent Writing: Brainstorming

**Skill D** Independent Writing: Writing Thesis Statements and Topic Sentences

**Vocabulary Review**



**Necessary Skills**

- Understanding information from both reading and listening passages
- Taking notes on the reading and listening passages
- Using information from your notes in your writing
- Synthesizing the information taken from both the reading and listening passages

| Process                                   | Strategy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Read and listen, then take notes          | <p>You will not see the prompt until after you finish reading and writing, so taking notes is essential.</p> <p>Take notes of major points from both reading and listening.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Read the question and understand the task | <p>Identify what kind of relationship between the reading and the listening the question asks you to discuss.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Select ideas from your notes              | <p>Choose the points that you need to discuss. Think about how the points in the lecture relate to the points in the reading. The listening passage will present details that will either challenge the information presented in the reading, present a counter example, or describe the consequences of an attempt to solve a problem presented in the reading.</p> |
| Organize the ideas                        | <p>Include information from both the reading and listening passages.</p> <p>Clearly show the relationship between the information presented in the listening and that presented in the reading passage.</p> <p>Limit the time for organizing to less than 2 minutes, in order to give yourself more time for writing and editing.</p>                                |

## Practice 1

### Step 1

Read the following passage. Then, look at the note diagram and fill in the missing information.

Should students in Turkey be allowed to wear their head scarves in class? This issue is currently under debate. There are even politicians in the Turkish parliament suggesting head scarves be banned by law. Most universities in Turkey have rules forbidding Muslim students from wearing head scarves inside buildings, but not all professors agree with these rules. Many professors are sympathetic toward their female Muslim students. Muslim women are typically uncomfortable not wearing head scarves in public.

**issue (n):**  
a topic of discussion or debate

**debate (n):**  
a discussion in which two or more different opinions on a topic are expressed

**parliament (n):**  
the top law-making group of politicians in a country

**ban (v):**  
to prohibit or forbid; to not allow

**sympathetic (adj):**  
feeling the same emotions as; relating to the feelings of

**Issue:** \_\_\_\_\_ head scarves in class

**Pro:** Some \_\_\_\_\_ in parliament, most \_\_\_\_\_

— proposed law

— existing \_\_\_\_\_ at universities

**Con:** Muslim women, many \_\_\_\_\_

— women \_\_\_\_\_ without head scarves

## Step 2



Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

Problem with head scarves: \_\_\_\_\_

— image of head scarves — old-fashioned, \_\_\_\_\_

— modern image — look like a \_\_\_\_\_ person

Another example of \_\_\_\_\_ fashion: the fez

— \_\_\_\_\_ hat for men

— banned in \_\_\_\_\_ 20<sup>th</sup> century

**image (n):**

a style; an opinion based on physical appearance

**tarnish (v):**

to damage the appearance of; to make imperfect

**outlaw (v):**

to ban by law; to make something punishable by law

**illegal (adj):**

contrary to the law; against the rules

**traditional (adj):**

in accordance with a standard that has been used for a long time



big deal  
public

early  
traditional

image  
uncivilized

outlawed  
Western

## Step 3

Review your notes from both the reading and the lecture. Pay attention to the main ideas and supporting details. Rewrite the ideas as complete sentences.

### Reading:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

### Lecture:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

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**Step 4**

Use the main ideas and details from Steps 1, 2, and 3 to complete the passage. Include information from both the reading and the lecture.

According to the reading, some people in \_\_\_\_\_ to ban head scarves  
\_\_\_\_\_. \_\_\_\_\_ politicians and \_\_\_\_\_ universities are in favor  
of \_\_\_\_\_ or laws \_\_\_\_\_ head scarves in class. However, Muslim women and some  
professors are \_\_\_\_\_ such rules and laws. Those who are against \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_ argue that they give Turkey a bad \_\_\_\_\_. Women wearing head scarves give  
Turkey an \_\_\_\_\_ or \_\_\_\_\_ image. This issue  
is similar to one in the past when the \_\_\_\_\_ in \_\_\_\_\_ outlawed \_\_\_\_\_ from  
wearing the \_\_\_\_\_ in public.

## Practice 2

### Step 1

Read the following passage. Then, look at the note diagram and fill in the missing information.

Many schools teach that Spanish explorer Christopher Columbus discovered the Americas. Did he really? Scientists have found evidence of a Viking village in Newfoundland that existed 500 years before Columbus sailed to the New World. Now, historians admit that Vikings reached North America first. Yet, many still contend that Columbus' voyage in 1492 was more important. The Vikings had only one village. Historians say Columbus opened the door for European settlement of the Americas.

**evidence (n):**

something helpful for making a conclusion

**admit (v):**

to say when one has committed a mistake; to confess

**contend (v):**

to say something is true; to maintain

**voyage (n):**

an extended trip, often by sea

**settlement (n):**

the process of starting communities in a new area

**Issue:** Who \_\_\_\_\_ the Americas?

**Vikings:** — had \_\_\_\_\_ in Newfoundland

— arrived five \_\_\_\_\_ years before Columbus

**Columbus:** — \_\_\_\_\_ say his voyage in \_\_\_\_\_ was more important

— opened the door for European \_\_\_\_\_

## Step 2



Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

**Question:** Did Columbus learn about North America in \_\_\_\_\_?

**Pro:** — he wrote in his \_\_\_\_\_ about visiting a land  
similar to Iceland in \_\_\_\_\_

— he might have learned about North America from the  
\_\_\_\_\_ in Iceland

**Con:** — details about Iceland in his diary were \_\_\_\_\_

— no other \_\_\_\_\_ that Columbus went to Iceland

**assert (v):**  
to say something is true; to maintain

**accurate (adj):**  
true; conforming exactly to fact

**mystery (n):**  
something not fully understood;  
an enigma

**remain (v):**  
to stay in a place or condition

**unsolved (adj):**  
not understood



North America  
wrong

Vikings  
evidence

1477  
continent

Iceland  
diary

## Step 3

Review your notes from both the reading and the lecture. Pay attention to the main ideas and supporting details. Rewrite the ideas as complete sentences.

### Reading:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

### Lecture:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

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**Step 4**

Use the main ideas and details from Steps 1, 2, and 3 above to complete the passage. Include information from both the reading and the lecture.

Did Christopher \_\_\_\_\_ really \_\_\_\_\_ the New World? We know that the \_\_\_\_\_ reached \_\_\_\_\_ 500 years before Columbus arrived in \_\_\_\_\_. Some \_\_\_\_\_ believe that Columbus visited \_\_\_\_\_ before he went to America. They think he learned about North America from the people there. However, there is not enough \_\_\_\_\_ to prove that this happened. Even though the \_\_\_\_\_ got there first, many \_\_\_\_\_ say that Columbus's \_\_\_\_\_ to North America was more important. The Vikings had only one \_\_\_\_\_ in Newfoundland. Columbus opened the door to European \_\_\_\_\_.

## Practice 3

### Step 1

Read the following passage. Then, look at the note diagram and fill in the missing information.

The Internet provides many exciting opportunities. You can research information, play games, and communicate with people all over the world. It's even possible to shop without leaving home! There are dangers to the Internet, however. For instance, children might access inappropriate information, such as websites about sex and gambling. In addition, someone could steal your personal information. There are also certain health problems related to the Internet. Using a computer too often can strain your eyes and hurt your back.

**research (v):**  
to study; to find out about  
**communicate (v):**  
to exchange ideas  
**access (v):**  
to enter; to gain use of  
**inappropriate (adj):**  
not suitable  
**strain (v):**  
to put pressure on

**Issue:** The \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_ of the Internet

**Pro:** Can: — \_\_\_\_\_ information  
— \_\_\_\_\_ with people all over the world  
— \_\_\_\_\_ from home

**Con:** Children can access \_\_\_\_\_ information  
Someone could steal \_\_\_\_\_  
Can be bad for your \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_

## Step 2

 Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

\_\_\_\_\_ of Net comes at a \_\_\_\_\_

— physical problems and \_\_\_\_\_ problems

Main problem of Net — \_\_\_\_\_ people from \_\_\_\_\_

— don't have \_\_\_\_\_ — \_\_\_\_\_ — \_\_\_\_\_  
contact

— forget \_\_\_\_\_ of others online

**invention (n):**

a new device or method of doing something

**encyclopedia (n):**

a reference book with information on various topics arranged alphabetically

**convenient (adj):**

easy to reach; comfortable to use or access

**isolated (adj):**

separated from others; solitary

**contact (n):**

a coming together; a connection

keywords  
key phrases

convenience  
isolates

dangers  
price

emotions  
social

face-to-face  
society

## Step 3

Review your notes from both the reading and the lecture. Pay attention to the main ideas and supporting details. Rewrite the ideas as complete sentences.

### Reading:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

### Lecture:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

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**Step 4**

Use the main ideas and details from Steps 1, 2, and 3 above to complete the passage. Include information from both the reading and the lecture.

The \_\_\_\_\_ is an amazing \_\_\_\_\_, but you should be careful how you use it. You can do lots of things on the Internet, such as \_\_\_\_\_ information, watching movies, \_\_\_\_\_ with people all over the world, and \_\_\_\_\_. However, as the reading points out, you may find bad things online, too. There are some websites that \_\_\_\_\_ should not see. Also, dishonest people may use the Internet to steal money or even steal your personal \_\_\_\_\_. The reading also says that using the Internet too often can cause \_\_\_\_\_ problems. On top of all this, the professor says in her lecture that the Internet also causes \_\_\_\_\_ problems. She says people may become \_\_\_\_\_ from society. They may also forget about other people's \_\_\_\_\_ online because they don't see those people \_\_\_\_\_ — \_\_\_\_\_ — \_\_\_\_\_.

## Skill A **Q1** Astronomy

### Practice 4

#### Step 1

Read the following passage. Then, look at the note diagram and fill in the missing information.

Is Pluto a planet? Scientists first believed that it was. Now, many are changing their minds. Like all planets, Pluto has enough gravity to pull itself into a sphere. It even has its own moon. Scientists have also detected that Pluto has a very thin atmosphere. All of these facts support the idea that Pluto is a planet. Since we have been calling it a planet since its discovery in 1930, a lot of people are in favor of just leaving it that way.

**distant (adj):**

faraway; remote

**area (n):**

a distinct part or section; a place

**sphere (n):**

a round, ball-shaped object

**detect (v):**

to find; to discover

**discovery (n):**

a finding of new knowledge

**Issue:** Is Pluto a \_\_\_\_\_?

— some \_\_\_\_\_ are changing their minds

**Pro:** — shaped like a \_\_\_\_\_

— has a \_\_\_\_\_

— has a thin \_\_\_\_\_

— been called a planet since \_\_\_\_\_

## Step 2



Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

Problem with Pluto's \_\_\_\_\_

Evidence that it is "not a \_\_\_\_\_"

— \_\_\_\_\_ to objects from \_\_\_\_\_

— is tiny

— fits definition of \_\_\_\_\_

— has a \_\_\_\_\_ orbit

**definition (n):**  
an understanding; a statement of characteristics

**classification (n):**  
a grouping; an organization

**similar (adj):**  
having many of the same features

**tilted (adj):**  
at an angle

**despite (prep):**  
in spite of; even though

keywords  
key phrases

classification  
planet

comet  
similar

gravity  
sphere

Kuiper Belt  
tilted

## Step 3

Review your notes from both the reading and the lecture. Pay attention to the main ideas and supporting details. Rewrite the ideas as complete sentences.

### Reading:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

### Lecture:

Main idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

Supporting idea: \_\_\_\_\_

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**Step 4**

Use the main ideas and details from Steps 1, 2, and 3 above to complete the passage. Include information from both the reading and the lecture.

Some scientists are thinking about changing the \_\_\_\_\_ of Pluto. Should it be called a \_\_\_\_\_? On one hand, the reading passage says Pluto has several characteristics \_\_\_\_\_ to a planet. It orbits a star, has enough \_\_\_\_\_ to form a \_\_\_\_\_, has an \_\_\_\_\_, and has a \_\_\_\_\_. On the other hand, the lecture explains that Pluto looks more like a \_\_\_\_\_ than a planet. Pluto is similar in size to other objects in the \_\_\_\_\_. It also has a \_\_\_\_\_ orbit, which is different than all of the other planets. Although Pluto has been called a planet since its \_\_\_\_\_ in 1930, maybe it is time to change Pluto's \_\_\_\_\_.

**Necessary Skills**

- Understanding the original text accurately
- Using your own words to convey essential information and ideas from the reading and listening
- Being able to express the same information using different vocabulary and sentence structure

**The Process of Paraphrasing**

- Understand the full meaning of the original text.
- Take notes on the passage. Write down key information including a few phrases, major points, and important details.
- WITHOUT looking at the original passage, paraphrase the information in your own words, just by looking at your notes.
- Check the original passage for any missed key information.

**Strategy**

- Use related words and phrases, including synonyms and antonyms of words and concepts in the original passage.

**Example:** The average daytime temperature in the Gobi desert does not often go below 38°C. → The average daytime temperature in the Gobi desert is usually at or above 38°C.

- Change word forms and rephrase to make things simpler.

**Example:** for organization → in order to organize  
people at the age of thirty → thirty-year-old people

- Use different sentence structure.

**Example:** Many Asian countries export rice to North America. →  
Rice is exported to North America by many Asian countries.

- Change the order of presentation of the information.
- Cite information from the original source by using signal words.

**Example:** According to the professor/passage, →  
The professor says/mentions/states/argues/believes/found that ...

## Practice 1

### Step 1

Read the following passage. Underline the main idea. Predict how the listening passage may contrast with the reading.

Bill Bryson has written several books on the history of the English language. He explains that Britain made English an international language in the 19<sup>th</sup> century with the expansion of its empire. Americans, though, have been the driving force behind the spread of English in the 20<sup>th</sup> century. Bryson asserts that America's commercial influence is a main factor. American exports reach every corner of the globe. America's cultural influence is another key factor. American movies, music, and books can be found almost everywhere.

**expansion (n):**  
the process of increasing in size

**factor (n):**  
something that contributes to a result or activity

**export (n):**  
a product sent to another country for sale

**globe (n):**  
the Earth

**key (adj):**  
important; necessary

### Step 2

Below is important information from the reading above. After each sentence are two possible paraphrases of it. Choose the best paraphrase for each sentence.

- A. America's commercial influence is a main factor.
1. The buying and selling power of America is one reason.
  2. This is one of the main things that Americans buy.
- B. America's cultural influence is another key factor.
1. A second reason is that American culture has influenced other countries.
  2. Americans are highly influenced by world culture.
- C. In the space below, write a paraphrase of the main idea that you underlined.

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### Step 3

Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

Factors driving spread of English

- Business
- Hollywood
- \_\_\_\_\_
  - \_\_\_\_\_ of online content in English
  - fewer \_\_\_\_\_ for searches not in English
  - \_\_\_\_\_ of hits for \_\_\_\_\_ in English
  - most \_\_\_\_\_ content available in American English

**ubiquitous (adj):**  
very common

**widespread (adj):**  
common in many places

**couple (adj):**  
two

**clearly (adv):**  
without doubt; not vaguely

**available (adj):**  
accessible; ready to be used

keywords /  
key phrases

English  
searches

hits  
spreading

majority  
Internet

millions  
uncommon

### Step 4

Look at the phrases and sentences from the lecture notes. Try to think of synonyms for the words listed. Write correct sentences to paraphrase these notes using the synonyms that you thought of.

A. majority of online content in English

synonyms: majority - \_\_\_\_\_  
online content - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

B. fewer hits for searches not in English

synonyms: fewer - \_\_\_\_\_  
not in English - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

### Step 5

#### A. Changing Keywords

Below are two incomplete paraphrases of key information from the lecture. Fill in the missing parts with words or phrases from the box. These words and phrases are synonyms or are similar in meaning to the actual words used in the lecture.

- driving/influencing/encouraging
- main/key/important
- presented/available/given
- in the past, today/years ago, these days/then, now
- most/the majority/the largest amount
- online content/information on the Web

1. Two \_\_\_\_\_ factors \_\_\_\_\_ the spread of English both \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_ are business and Hollywood.
2. \_\_\_\_\_ of \_\_\_\_\_ in English is \_\_\_\_\_ in American English.

#### B. Changing Sentence Structure

Try to complete the following paraphrases of the sentences from part A above.

1. American businesses and Hollywood are two key factors that \_\_\_\_\_
2. Typically, American English is what is used \_\_\_\_\_

### Step 6

Read the following sentences taken from the reading and the lecture. Create new sentences by combining the ideas in each pair of sentences.

(A) Americans, though, have been the driving force behind the spread of English in the 20<sup>th</sup> century.

(B) American English has become so ubiquitous—that is, widespread—for several reasons.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_

(A) American movies, music, and books can be found almost everywhere.

(B) Another key factor driving the spread of English today is the Internet.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_

## Practice 2

### Step 1

Read the following passage. Underline the main idea. Predict how the listening passage may contrast with the reading.

Before now, people usually thought of sunlight as a friend. It's a fairly new idea that sunlight is actually harmful. We often go out in the heat of the day. This may be one reason it harms us. The hour before sunrise and the hour after sunset are cooler. Many animals that live outside are most active in those times. Perhaps they know how to use sunlight more wisely than we do. During the early and later parts of the day, we are exposed to fewer harmful rays from the sun.

**actually (adv):**

really; truly

**harmful (adj):**

able to damage or hurt

**active (adj):**

not at rest; in movement or at work

**wisely (adv):**

in a wise, or smart, way

**expose (v):**

to be touched by; to be near or in the presence of

### Step 2

Below is important information from the reading above. After each sentence are two possible paraphrases of it. Choose the best paraphrase for each sentence.

- A. Many animals that live outside are most active in those times.
  1. It is during these times that a lot of outdoor animals are busiest.
  2. Many outside animals are more active than people in the morning or at night.
- B. During the early and later parts of the day, we are exposed to fewer harmful rays from the sun.
  1. Early in the morning and late in the evening, not as many harmful rays from the sun hit us.
  2. We should be exposed to less harmful sunlight later on in the day.
- C. In the space below, write a paraphrase of the main idea that you underlined.

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### Step 3



Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

How sunlight helps us:

A) Prevents illness

B) Kills \_\_\_\_\_

— hospitals without much \_\_\_\_\_ have \_\_\_\_\_ germs

— \_\_\_\_\_ with more sunlight have \_\_\_\_\_ germs

— more sunlight → people recover \_\_\_\_\_

**disease (n):**

a sickness; an illness

**germ (n):**

a microorganism that may cause sickness

**bacteria (n):**

single-celled microorganisms that may cause sickness

**recover (v):**

to regain health after a sickness

**reconsider (v):**

to think about an idea or belief again after gaining new knowledge

keywords /  
key phrases

sunlight  
bacteria

fewer  
more

less  
hospitals

glass  
faster

### Step 4

Look at the phrases and sentences from the lecture notes. Try to think of synonyms for the words listed. Write correct sentences to paraphrase these notes using the synonyms that you thought of.

A. Sunlight kills germs that cause sickness.

synonyms: germs - \_\_\_\_\_

sickness - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

B. recover faster

synonyms: recover - \_\_\_\_\_

faster - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

### Step 5

#### A. Changing Keywords

Below are two incomplete paraphrases of key information from the lecture. Fill in the missing parts with words or phrases from the box. These words and phrases are synonyms or are similar in meaning to the actual words used in the lecture.

- |                                                    |                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| • light/rays/sunbeams                              | • fatal/life threatening/deadly |
| • prevent/stop/heal                                | • illnesses/sicknesses/diseases |
| • harm/hurt/damage/injure/impair                   | • giving them/causing/inducing  |
| • solar light/light from the sun/rays from the sun | • serious/dangerous/severe      |

1. \_\_\_\_\_ can actually \_\_\_\_\_ or cure a lot of \_\_\_\_\_ that can be \_\_\_\_\_.
2. Even though \_\_\_\_\_ from the sun can sometimes \_\_\_\_\_ people by \_\_\_\_\_ skin cancer, it isn't usually \_\_\_\_\_.

#### B. Changing Sentence Structure

Try to complete the following paraphrases of the sentences from part A above.

1. A lot of these illnesses that can be life threatening \_\_\_\_\_
2. It's true that sunlight can cause \_\_\_\_\_

### Step 6

Read the following sentences taken from the reading and the lecture. Create new sentences by combining the ideas in each pair of sentences.

- (A) Many animals that live outside are most active in those times.  
(B) Perhaps they know how to use sunlight more wisely than we do.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_

- (A) Sunlight can keep people from getting many diseases.  
(B) Sunlight can kill germs or bacteria that cause sickness.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_

### Practice 3

#### Step 1

Read the following passage. Underline the main idea. Predict how the listening passage may contrast with the reading.

Everything that we know of is made of something called atoms. They are made of particles called electrons, protons, and neutrons. When atoms are split, large amounts of heat and energy are created. This is called nuclear power. Scientists can use this energy to make electricity. A steam turbine and then a generator are used to convert nuclear power into electricity. Although many people have fears about nuclear power, it is an excellent way to make electricity.

**split (v):**  
to cut in two; to divide

**energy (n):**  
the capacity for work or activity

**nuclear (adj):**  
relating to the split nuclei of atoms

**generator (n):**  
a machine that changes energy into electricity

**convert (v):**  
a change from one form to another

#### Step 2

Below is important information from the reading above. After each sentence are two possible paraphrases of it. Choose the best paraphrase for each sentence.

- A. Scientists can use this energy to make electricity.
1. Scientists are able to produce electricity from that type of energy.
  2. Scientists convert nuclear power into electricity.
- B. Although many people have fears about nuclear power, it is an excellent way to make electricity.
1. Though there are fears about how the electricity is made, people support the use of nuclear power in this way.
  2. Nuclear power is a good way to make electricity even though lots of people have fears about it.
- C. In the space below, write a paraphrase of the main idea that you underlined.

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### Step 3

 Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

Reasons for not using \_\_\_\_\_ power:

- A) waste is deadly \_\_\_\_\_
- B) \_\_\_\_\_ can happen
- C) high cost for \_\_\_\_\_
  - \_\_\_\_\_ boxes needed to bury waste
  - takes \_\_\_\_\_ time to break down

**create (v):**

to make; to produce

**waste (n):**

garbage; useless material that remains after a process

**handle (v):**

to deal with; to take care of; to transport

**durable (adj):**

strong; rugged; able to withstand violence and time

**finally (adv):**

in the end; lastly

**keywords /  
key phrases**

Russians  
nuclear

ground  
safety

long  
accidents

poison  
durable

### Step 4

Look at the phrases and sentences from the lecture notes. Try to think of synonyms for the words listed. Write correct sentences to paraphrase these notes using the synonyms that you thought of.

**A. accidents can happen**

synonyms: accident - \_\_\_\_\_

happen - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

**B. durable boxes needed to bury waste**

synonyms: durable - \_\_\_\_\_

needed - \_\_\_\_\_

bury - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

### Step 5

#### A. Changing Keywords

Below are two incomplete paraphrases of key information from the lecture. Fill in the missing parts with words or phrases from the box. These words and phrases are synonyms or are similar in meaning to the actual words used in the lecture.

- |                                            |                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| • costs a great deal/costs a lot/is costly | • nuclear reactors/atomic energy plants/buildings where nuclear power is made |
| • a lot of/many/a large number of          | • trees, flowers, and shrubs/flora/greenery                                   |
| • caused/done                              | • injury/damage/harm                                                          |

- \_\_\_\_\_ has already been \_\_\_\_\_ to \_\_\_\_\_ people, \_\_\_\_\_, and animals.
- Making the \_\_\_\_\_ safe \_\_\_\_\_.

#### B. Changing Sentence Structure

Try to complete the following paraphrases of the sentences from part A above.

- Already, many people, plants, and animals have been \_\_\_\_\_
- The cost is very high \_\_\_\_\_

### Step 6

Read the following sentences taken from the reading and the lecture. Create new sentences by combining the ideas in each pair of sentences.

- (A) This is called nuclear power.  
(B) Scientists can use this energy to make electricity.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

- (A) There is one main reason for not using it.  
(B) The waste is a deadly poison.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

## Practice 4

## Step 1

Read the following passage. Underline the main idea. Predict how the listening passage may contrast with the reading.

What killed the dinosaurs? The cause of the extinction of dinosaurs is unclear. One theory argues that gradual changes on Earth made the dinosaurs die out. Scientists have been looking for clues that will help support this theory. For example, from the location of various dinosaur bones, scientists believe these huge animals walked long distances to find food. This might indicate plants in one area died for some reason, so the dinosaurs moved to a new area. As it became harder and harder to find food, more dinosaurs died out. Finally, when no more food could be found, the dinosaurs became extinct.

**extinction (n):**

the process in which a type of animal or plant disappears from Earth

**theory (n):**

a set of ideas used to explain an event

**clue (n):**

a hint; information that suggests an answer to a question

**gradual (adj):**

slow; not sudden

**die out (v phrase):**

to become extinct; to die without producing offspring

## Step 2

Below is important information from the reading above. After each sentence are two possible paraphrases of it. Choose the best paraphrase for each sentence.

- A. The cause of the extinction of dinosaurs is unclear.
1. The reason the dinosaurs disappeared from Earth is not known for certain.
  2. Scientists disagree on the clarity of dinosaur extinction.
- B. As it became harder and harder to find food, more dinosaurs died out.
1. More and more dinosaurs died out because they could not find food.
  2. The dinosaurs contributed to a lack of food.
- C. In the space below, write a paraphrase of the main idea that you underlined.

---

---

### Step 3

 Now listen to a lecture related to the topic in Step 1. Fill in the blanks of the note diagram below with the keywords or key phrases shown. Not all of the words or phrases will be used.

Dinosaur extinction:

Suddenly killed when \_\_\_\_\_ from space \_\_\_\_\_ the Earth

Clue = \_\_\_\_\_ in ocean near Mexico

After Earth was hit:

- \_\_\_\_\_ and dust flew into \_\_\_\_\_
- some dinosaurs killed by \_\_\_\_\_ or explosion
- some dinosaurs died because of \_\_\_\_\_ or no food

**sudden (adj):**

quick; without warning

**disappear (v):**

to vanish; to become nonexistent

**huge (adj):**

very large

**crater (n):**

a bowl-shaped hole made by the collision of one object into another

**impact (n):**

a collision; the hitting of one object into another

keywords /  
key phrases

atmosphere  
hit

cold weather  
object

crater  
plants

floods  
steam

### Step 4

Look at the phrases and sentences from the lecture notes. Try to think of synonyms for the words listed. Write correct sentences to paraphrase these notes using the synonyms that you thought of.

A. suddenly killed when object from space hit the Earth

synonyms: suddenly - \_\_\_\_\_  
killed - \_\_\_\_\_  
object from space - \_\_\_\_\_  
hit - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

B. some dinosaurs killed by floods or explosion

synonyms: floods - \_\_\_\_\_  
explosion - \_\_\_\_\_

paraphrase: \_\_\_\_\_

### Step 5

#### A. Changing Keywords

Below are two incomplete paraphrases of key information from the lecture. Fill in the missing parts with words or phrases from the box. These words and phrases are synonyms or are similar in meaning to the actual words used in the lecture.

- suddenly/quickly/very fast
- at the same time/at once/suddenly
- other researchers/some people/others
- slowly/little by little/over time/bit by bit/gradually
- became different/changed
- thought/idea/theory

1. That the Earth \_\_\_\_\_ very slowly, causing dinosaurs to die out \_\_\_\_\_, is one \_\_\_\_\_.
2. One \_\_\_\_\_ that \_\_\_\_\_ believe is that a change caused the dinosaurs to die \_\_\_\_\_.

#### B. Changing Sentence Structure

Try to complete the following paraphrases of the sentences from part A above.

1. Very gradual changes on the Earth caused dinosaurs \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
2. Others argue that dinosaurs disappeared \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

### Step 6

Read the following sentences taken from the reading and the lecture. Create new sentences by combining the ideas in each pair of sentences.

(A) One idea is that gradual changes on Earth made them die out.

(B) The other is that they were killed by something that hit Earth.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

(A) Scientists study the very old bones of animals in rocks.

(B) They can see that many animals have disappeared.

(A)+(B): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

### Necessary Skills

- Describing a personal experience
- Expressing an opinion on an issue and supporting it with concrete examples and details
- Organizing ideas in an effective way

| Process                                   | Strategy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Read the question and understand the task | Be sure that you understand the question and what the question requires you to do.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Brainstorm                                | <p>Try to take less than 5 minutes to brainstorm.</p> <p>Write down all the ideas you can think of to support your opinion.</p> <p>Think of ways to express those ideas in English.</p> <p>Do not try to organize these points. You will select major ideas and organize them in the next step.</p> |
| Organize ideas                            | <p>Select major ideas that can be developed into topics.</p> <p>Do NOT include ideas that are unconnected to the task or main topics.</p> <p>Organize so that minor ideas act to support the major ideas.</p> <p>Select examples that clearly support the topics.</p>                               |

- Your organization may look like this.

#### Introduction

Restatement of the question  
Thesis statement

#### Body

Support idea 1 + examples  
Support idea 2 + examples  
Support idea 3 + examples

#### Conclusion

Restatement of the thesis

## Practice 1

### Step 1

Read the question and think about your own experience. List some ideas about your experiences in the blanks.

Some people learn by reading about things. Others learn by doing things. Which of these methods of learning is better for you? Use specific reasons and examples to support your choice.

Things I learned by reading:

math

changing the ink in my printer

---



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Things I learned by doing:

swimming

installing programs on my computer

---



---

### Step 2

Read the sample response below and underline three sentences that are central to the organization of the passage.

We learn new things all the time. When we are children, we learn information from our parents, from our friends, or from teachers in school. When we are adults, we learn things from older people, from colleagues, or even from younger people. Although we are all learning all the time, people learn in different ways. Some people learn by reading. Others learn by doing. Personally, I learn better by doing than by reading.

One thing I learned by doing was how to install programs on my computer. This is a simple thing if you know how to do it. If you do not already know, it can be confusing. The first time I got a new program for my computer, I read the instructions for how to install it. I did not really understand the instructions. It seemed like they were written in a foreign language. Then, I put the CD in my computer. I pushed buttons and clicked with my mouse. I installed the program without the instructions at all. Now, I know how to install any program on my computer.

Some people disagree with my point of view. They say they have to read the instructions to learn how to do things. They do not want to make any mistakes. I think it is OK to make mistakes. When I make a mistake, I learn not to do it that way again. I also learn what happens when I make that mistake. These are both important things to know when you learn to do something new.

**information (n):**

facts; knowledge

**adult (n):**

a person over the age of 18; not a child

**colleague (n):**

a coworker

**personally (adv):**

as far as I'm concerned; in my case

**install (v):**

to put in place; to load into a computer

**program (n):**

a series of coded instructions that make a computer perform a specific function

**confusing (adj):**

difficult to understand clearly

**instructions (n):**

directions that tell how to do something

**foreign (adj):**

from a different place; different in origin

**mistake (n):**

an incorrect act, an error

---

**Step 3**

Answer the following questions in relation to the thesis and topic of the response in Step 2.

1. What is the thesis statement of the essay? (Write it.)

---

---

2. What is the topic sentence of the body paragraph? (Write it.)

---

---

**Step 4**

Answer the following questions in relation to the organization of the response in Step 2.

1. Which "side" of the prompt does this essay take?

---

---

2. What example does the writer give to support the thesis statement?

---

---

3. Does the writer present a comment or idea from the other side in the conclusion? If so, what is the comment or idea?

---

---

4. What is the main idea of the conclusion?

---

---

Read the sample response presenting another possible answer to the prompt from Step 1.

Do you learn by reading about things, or do you learn by doing things? For me, the best way of learning is by reading. I can learn more information in a shorter period of time by reading than I could by doing. If I have to participate in an activity in order to learn it, it takes a long time. Also, I think learning by reading is better than learning by doing.

I love to read, so I am absorbing information from books all the time. For example, I recently read a book about Africa. I learned a lot of information about Africa from that book. If I had to actually travel to Africa to learn about it, it would take a lot of time. It would also cost a lot of money to travel to Africa. So, learning about a new place is more convenient and more affordable by reading about that place.

Some people say that experience is a better teacher than books. They insist that they can remember things better if they do them rather than just read about them. I think learning that way is too limited. Even if I traveled to Africa to learn about it, I would only see a small part of Africa. There would be many features I would never learn about because I would not see them. On the other hand, I could read about many different features in one book and learn tons of things. Reading is the best way to learn.

**period (n):**

an interval of time

**participate (v):**

to take part; to actively do something

**activity (n):**

a task that requires action or movement

**absorb (v):**

to take in; to retain

**in spite of (prep phrase):**

despite; even though

**recently (adv):**

in recent times; not long ago

**affordable (adj):**

not expensive

**insist (v):**

to be confident of an opinion; to not yield

**limited (adj):**

restricted; constrained

**feature (n):**

a characteristic; a trait; a quality

### Step 5

After studying the two sample responses, give your own opinion on the prompt. Brainstorm your own ideas below. Then, type your essay on a computer.

Brainstorming

## Skill C **Q2** Experience

### Practice 2

#### Step 1

Read the question and think about your own experience. List some ideas about your experiences in the blanks.

Neighbors are the people who live near us. In your opinion, what are the qualities of a good neighbor? Use specific details and examples in your answer.

Good Neighbors:

are helpful when needed

respect other neighbors' privacy

Bad Neighbors:

are noisy

don't mind their own business/are nosy

#### Step 2

Read the sample response below and underline three sentences that are central to the organization of the passage.

It's important to have good neighbors. I am lucky to have very good neighbors where we live. I think our neighbors are good because they have been friendly since the first day we moved in. Also, whenever a neighborly thing should be done, they always cooperate, or help out. People sometimes complain that their neighbors are difficult, but we have never had any problems with our neighbors. On the contrary, we like our neighbors a lot and we think that our neighbors like us. Two qualities that make a good neighbor, then, are friendliness and helpfulness.

Our neighbors are good neighbors because they are friendly and helpful. I remember the first summer we moved in. One of our neighbors saw that we were new, so she introduced us to her family and told us to ask her if we ever needed anything. In the weeks that followed, the weather was hot and she invited our kids to swim with her children at the pool. Since then, our children and hers have become good friends. Before leaving for summer vacation, we were worried about leaving our house empty for two weeks. Our neighbor offered to collect the letters from our mailbox every day and to make sure our house was OK. Now, whenever she and her family go away, we help them in the same way and keep an eye on their house.

Most people realize that having good neighbors is very important. Indeed, I was lucky to have kind and helpful neighbors with whom we quickly became friends. But I also learned a valuable lesson from these neighbors. I learned the one thing as important as having a good neighbor is being a good neighbor yourself.

**cooperate (v):**

to work or act together

**difficult (adj):**

not easy to get along with; troublesome

**contrary (adj):**

in opposite to what was stated or expected

**quality (n):**

a characteristic; a trait

**introduce (v):**

to present or tell about someone for the first time

**empty (adj):**

not occupied; with nobody inside

**offer (v):**

to make available; to volunteer

**collect (v):**

to take and keep

**keep an eye on**

**(v phrase/idiom):**

to watch for trouble; to keep safe

**realize (v):**

to understand; to know

---

**Step 3**

Answer the following questions in relation to the thesis and topic of the response in Step 2.

1. What is the thesis statement of the essay? (Write it.)

---

---

2. What is the topic sentence of the body paragraph? (Write it.)

---

---

**Step 4**

Answer the following questions in relation to the organization of the response in Step 2.

1. What personal experience is the essay about?

---

---

2. What example does the writer give to support the thesis statement?

---

---

3. How many sentences in the conclusion restate ideas previously mentioned in the essay?

---

---

4. What is the main idea of the conclusion?

---

---

Read the sample response presenting another possible answer to the prompt from Step 1.

My mother thinks we have good neighbors, but I do not agree. She says our neighbors are friendly and kind, but I think they are much too nosy. I believe our neighbors always come to our house and try to be helpful because they cannot mind their own business! In my opinion, "good fences make good neighbors."

Our neighbors cannot stay on their side of the fence. I thought our neighbors were too nosy from the very first day we moved in. First, as the movers unloaded the truck, I could see them smiling at us from their yard. Then, they continued looking as if they wanted to see all the furniture that we had. Furthermore, I did not like being told by my mother to be nice to our neighbor's children. Finally, while on summer vacation, I was angry that our neighbors collected our mail and came to our house every day. Now, they know everyone who sends us letters, and I wonder if they looked in my room. Indeed, I never asked to know our neighbors and I never wanted them to come so freely to our house.

Even though my mother considers our neighbors to be friends, I feel like our neighbors invaded our privacy. I understand it is important to be friendly, but I think it is more important to respect people's privacy. Good neighbors stay on their side of the fence. They are the ones who keep a little bit of distance, not the ones who try to get too close.

**nosy (adj):**

too interested in other people's lives and business

**mind (your own) business (v phrase):**

to not be nosy; to not ask personal questions

**unload (v):**

to remove a group of objects from some place or vehicle

**continue (v):**

to carry on

**furniture (n):**

movable objects in a room for sitting, eating, sleeping, etc.

**come back (v phrase):**

to return

**consider (v):**

to think of; to believe

**invade (v):**

to intrude; to go where you're not wanted

**privacy (n):**

the condition of being free from unwanted people and noise

**respect (n):**

to treat with consideration; to recognize as valid

**Step 5**

After studying the two sample responses, give your own opinion on the prompt. Brainstorm your own ideas below. Then, type your essay on a computer.

Brainstorming